

Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

Epic Overview Document

1. Epic Summary

The Brainstorming & Ideation phase is the starting point of the project. The team explores the problem space, generates a wide range of ideas, and narrows them down to the most promising concepts that move forward to design and development.

2. Goals

- Understand the problem and the target users clearly.
- Generate a large number of diverse ideas without early judgement.
- Evaluate and prioritize ideas against agreed criteria.
- Select the best concept(s) and align all stakeholders.

3. Key Activities

Activity	Description	Output
Problem definition	Define the problem statement, scope and constraints.	Problem statement
User research	Interviews, surveys, and competitor analysis to understand needs.	Research notes, personas
Brainstorming sessions	Group ideation using mind maps, Crazy 8s, SCAMPER, How-Might-We.	Raw idea list
Idea clustering	Group similar ideas and remove duplicates.	Themed idea clusters
Idea evaluation	Score ideas on impact, effort, feasibility and user value.	Prioritization matrix
Concept selection	Stakeholder review and final decision on ideas to pursue.	Selected concepts

4. Sample User Stories

ID	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-01	As a team member, I want to submit ideas so that everyone's input is captured.	Ideas can be added with title and description; visible to all.

ID	User Story	Acceptance Criteria
US-02	As a facilitator, I want to group ideas into themes so that discussion is organized.	Ideas can be tagged and clustered; duplicates flagged.
US-03	As a stakeholder, I want to vote/score ideas so that priorities are clear.	Each idea has a score; ranking is shown.
US-04	As a product owner, I want a final shortlist so that I can plan the next phase.	Shortlist documented with rationale.

5. Deliverables

- Problem statement and scope document
- User personas and research summary
- Consolidated idea backlog
- Prioritization matrix
- Selected concept(s) with rationale

6. Timeline (Suggested)

Week	Focus
Week 1	Problem definition and user research
Week 2	Brainstorming sessions and idea clustering
Week 3	Evaluation, prioritization and concept selection

7. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Product Owner	Owns vision, makes final selection decision
Facilitator / Scrum Master	Runs sessions and keeps the process on track
Team Members	Contribute ideas and participate in evaluation
Stakeholders	Provide feedback and approve the shortlist

8. Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Dominant voices limit idea diversity	Use silent writing before group discussion
Too many ideas, no focus	Use clear evaluation criteria and time-boxing
Ideas not tied to user needs	Ground sessions in research findings

9. Success Criteria

- Problem statement agreed by all stakeholders
- Minimum target number of ideas generated
- Shortlist approved and ready for the Design phase